

National Exam of Higher National Diploma 2023 Session

Spécialty/option : All Specialties

Paper: English Language

Duration : 2 hours

Credit : 1/2

SECTION A: READING COMPREHENSION (20 mks)

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.

Defeat of the mind is the surest evidence of defeat of the man himself. In our nation today, the most common and overused statement is "the youths of today are the leaders of tomorrow". But how true is this statement? It is no news that youths in our nation have already been defeated in their minds by the notion that leadership is only for the old and red headed. This is a false perspective from which to look at things. A famous public speaker Denzel Washington said "Without commitment, you will never start. But more importantly, without consistency, you will never finish". Let us analyse this in our 21st Century context.

Commitment is a virtue that has proven to guide and govern the 21st Century world. It is the first step to progress and inherent success. President Donald J. Trump was a real trump card in the most recent Presidential elections in the United States of America. For him, there was hardly ever any sign of positive progress; still, he proved his person and won the position. Remember that even US citizens were taken aback when the results were declared. He was committed to the cause and so he started it, but had he not been consistent, he would have lost without a doubt even before the end.

Look at George Weah, President of the Republic of Liberia and former soccer player in Cameroon. I believe it was the scariest part of his life when he decided to retire from international soccer to dare into politics. Some anonymous reports even hold that he left because he wasn't fully accomplished where he was at the time. If this is true, then I can start imagining what went through his mind. Thoughts like there is more potential in me than football can explore. When this crossed his mind, he decided to make the difference in his country. Even

after many failed attempts against his predecessor, when the time came, his capable hands were the only available ones for the job.

At this point, I must say just as great and successful figures do that "True success only comes when opportunity meets preparation" (anonymous). President George Weah was committed, **consistent** and prepared; when the opportunity came, he succeeded.

Did you know that Davido's father is Daliko Dangote; one of the world's richest black men? If you knew, I didn't. When I found out this, I asked myself a **multi-million dollar question**; what will a typical Cameroonian youth do if put in Davido's shoes? He will probably sit back, relax and spend money **outrageously**. Interestingly, he will do this with no sense of purpose or positive drive. Yet, you want to lead tomorrow. .

I stand here today, as a voice of inspiration and a beacon of hope to say that it is not over yet. If only we could value schools more than nightclubs, books more than clothes and education more than fashion, then we can make for ourselves a better tomorrow. Remember that **rock bottom** can also serve as a solid foundation on which to build the mansion of our desired society. Young Cameroonians; stop existing and start living.

Questions

1. What type of write up (essay) is employed above? (1mk)
2. List the other essay types that you know in English writing. (2mks)
3. What is the paragraph format used in the passage you just read? (1mk)
4. Carefully identify and write out the take home message above. (2mks)
5. Write out the bolded words and provide the most suitable antonyms (opposites) in your answer sheets. (2mks)
6. "True success only comes when opportunity meets preparation" (anonymous). What is your interpretation of this statement? (2mks)
7. Following public speaking and writing, what name will you give to this text/passage?(1mk)
 - a. Speech
 - b. Talk
 - c. Discourse
 - d. Campaign
8. Which is the dominant tense used in the passage above?(1mk)
 - a. The future imperfect
 - b. The perfect present

c. The present simple

d. The past perfect

9. According to the passage, state two ways that Cameroonian youth are encouraged. (2mks)
10. Paragraph 5 uses 2 question types which have been underlined. Identify the two question types used in that paragraph. (2mks)
11. Apart from the two question types used in question 10 above, list the other question types that you know. (2mks)
12. Write down the names of 4 role models who appear in the passage. (2mks)

SECTION B: GRAMMAR AND VOCABULARY (30 marks)

GRAMMAR (10 marks)

I. Fill in the blanks with one of the adjectives in brackets (5 marks)

1. He is the (strong) boy in the whole school. (1mk)
2. Of the two sisters, Mary is the (beautiful) (1mk)
3. Ann is the (young) of four sisters. (1mk)
4. David is (bad) than his brother (1mk)
5. Which of the two girls is (tall)? (1mk)

II. Match the sentence parts in column A with the appropriate ones in column B. Write the correct sentence in the space provided (5 marks).

	Column A	Column B
1	Bantar went to the market	a) If I worked had
2	The teacher gave his students more marks	b) if I went to school.
3	Sarah went to the hospital	c) to get some food stuff.
4	I would have passed my exams	d) for check-up
5	I would have had money	e) in order for them to pass their exams

- 1.....(1mk)
- 2.....(1mk)
- 3.....(1mk)
- 4.....(1mk)
- 5.....(1mk)

VOCABULARY (20 marks)

I. Complete the following sentences with suitable words (5marks)

1. Gabriel, how would you refuse to help your mother with the.....(1mk)
2. All names of places begin with.....letters. (1mk)
3. I do not eat before going to church. I take some..... in the morning and then I eat dinner at home with my family. (1mk)
4. Blood shortage in the body is also referred to as.....(1mk)
5. Aids is real,? (1mk)

II. Find the appropriate part in column B that fits with that of column A. Write out the full expression in the spaces provided. (6 marks)

	Column A	Column B
1	It is often difficult	a) Twice shy
2	To take care	b) nor pink color
3	The most intelligent girl	c) To say "sorry"
4	It is disrespectful	d) of someone
5	Once beaten	e) in school
6	It is neither rose	f) to scorn someone

- 1.....(1mk)
- 2.....(1mk)
- 3.....(1mk)
- 4.....(1mk)
- 5.....(1mk)
- 6.....(1mk)

III. Link the following pairs of sentences using the words supplied in the brackets.

(5 marks)

1. The man is shopping in the market. The man is my brother (who) (1mk)
2. The car was stolen. The car has been found (which). (1mk)
3. Ngong is not sure. He shall go to the party (that). (1mk)
4. Shella and Cynthia boarded a bike. There were no taxis (because) (1mk)
5. Epie delayed. It was raining (since). (1mk)

Circle the word in which the underlined word is pronounced differently (4marks)

1. Pound, stout, though, mouth. (1mk)
2. Tear, near, gear, tease (1mk)
3. Kneel, peel, heel, peer (1mk)
4. Suit, put, shoot, shut (1mk)

SECTION C: SPOKEN ENGLISH (20 marks)

I. Complete the sentences with the correct word chosen from the brackets (5 marks)

1. The President.....his wife, is going abroad for a diplomatic concern. (and, with, for) (1mk)
2. The Manager and.....did all the work yesterday. (I, me, ourselves) (1mk)
3. Look at that couple, they truly love.....(each other, themselves, one another) (1mk)
4. The Director was very angry.....the problem that occurred. (with, at, for) (1mk)
5. Tell me what you are good.....doing. (wit, in, at) (1mk)

II. Complete the sentences with suitable words. (5 marks)

1. He is too selfish, he does not really care.....other people around him. (1mk)
2. They all sat.....the table to eat. (1mk)
3. You have all the credentials needed for the job, why don't you apply.....it (1mk)
4. The boss congratulated me.....my success in the assignment given to me. (1mk)
5. He spends all his time lying.....bed. (1mk)

III. Circle the odd sound. (10 marks)

1. Sure, send, shy (1mk)
2. Unveil, university, youth (1mk)
3. Laugh, phone, though (1mk)
4. Exist, exam, excellent (1mk)
5. Go, no, women (1mk)
6. Player, mayor, maior (1mk)
7. Girls, zeal, since (1mk)
8. Power, shown, hour (1mk)

9. Great, grateful, meal (1mk)

10. Thin, thick, this (1mk)

SECTION D: WRITING COMPETENCE (30 marks)

Write an essay on one of the following topics (between 250 to 300 words).

1. On the National Youth day, you have been requested by the Management of your school in the presence of the Governor to make a speech on the importance of language to professional students. As the president of the Students Union of your school, write your speech.
2. Insecurity at workplaces
3. You are the secretary of the staff of the regional hospital in Bamenda. Write minutes of the meeting of this body.